

# 'Cats Face Miner Mound Ace Today

(Continued from 1C, Col 4)

hasn't looked too good in the outfield. But he certainly has pitched."

Arizona coach Jerry Kindall will counter with the Wildcats' leading pitcher in today's opener. Right-hander Dave Breuker, 10-0 for the season, will start the game. National Collegiate Athletic Assn. statistics for the District 7 region released Thursday showed Breuker as the top pitcher in the Rocky Mountain area. He ranked at the top of the list for most wins and most strikeouts with 57. He has pitched three complete games and has two shutouts to his credit.

Breuker ranked fourth in the district with a 1.67 earned run average.

Kindall said right-handers Mark Schimpf (9-0) and Joel Godfrey (6-1) will pitch the two games Saturday. Cohen said he will go with right-handers Dan Modlinski (3-2) and Jeff Hogan (2-2) Saturday.

Leading the Miners at the plate this season are outfielder Joe Pennies (.386), third baseman Glenn Villarreal (.396) and utility man Terry Dillingham (.420). Cohen pointed to Pennies, a 5-10, 175-pound switch-hitting veteran, as his team leader.

"Joe has been an outstanding player for us this year," Cohen said. "He's improved so much I don't believe I'd trade him for any outfielder in the entire conference, even though I haven't seen them all."

But Kindall has a few solid players also. Third baseman Ron Hassey is the second leading hitter in District 7 with a .463 average, which includes 10 doubles, three triples and eight home runs. He leads the district with 61 runs batted in.

Catcher Dennis Haines, with a .429 batting average, ranks third among District 7 hitters

Haines leads the Rocky Mountain area with 10 home runs for the year.

First baseman Marv Thompson is the third Wildcat currently hitting above the .400 mark. His .426 average places him fourth on the District 7 list and he leads the region with 18 doubles and seven triples. He is second to Hassey in the RBI category with 51 for the year.

The Miners were 21-11 and 1-2 in the Southern Division for the season entering a Thursday doubleheader in El Paso against McNeese State. The UTEP batters are hitting .321 as a team.

Kindall said the Miners, who have finished last in the Southern Division four out of the last five years, are definitely more dangerous this year.

"They are a much better club than last year," he said, "and they already knocked off

Arizona State. They can score runs as they proved in the ASU series. Texas-El Paso is an unpredictable club and for that reason we must be on guard every moment."

The Wildcats lead the Southern Division with a 3-0 record and are 43-2 for the year. Arizona is seeking its 20th straight win. Arizona's longest winning streak was 25 in a row in 1966. With a sweep of the UTEP series the 'Cats could get a crack at tying the record when they travel to Tempe next week for a three-game series against Arizona State.

Arizona State, the second place team in the Southern Division with a 2-1 record, hosts New Mexico for a three-game series today and Saturday. The Sun Devils, runners-up to Southern California in last year's College World Series, are winless in four tries at new Packard Stadium, having lost a single game to the NCAA champion Trojans and a three-game series to LaVerne College this week.